IGCSE 0607 Practice Questions — E2.7 — Combined Questions & Markscheme

Sequences

Total Questions: 24 — **Total Marks:** 140 Marks

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  → **Paper 2 (Non-Calculator)** *(10 Qs)* · **Paper 4 (Calculator)** *(14 Qs)*

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1 Here are the first five terms of a number sequence.

7 11 15 19 23

(a) Write down the next term in this sequence.

..... **[1]**

(b) Find an expression, in terms of n, for the nth term of this sequence.

..... **[2]**

2 Here are the first four terms of a sequence.

5 11 17 23

(a) Find the next term of this sequence.

..... **[1]**

(b) Find an expression for the nth term of this sequence.

..... **[2]**

(c) Explain why 150 is not a term in this sequence.

..... **[1]**

3 Here are the first four terms of a sequence.

5 12 19 26

(a) Write down the next term in the sequence.

..... **[1]**

(b) Find an expression for the nth term of the sequence.

..... **[2]**

(c) Explain why 150 is not a term in this sequence.

..... **[1]**

4 Here are the first four terms of a sequence.

5 11 17 23

(a) Find the next term in this sequence.

..... **[1]**

(b) Find an expression for the nth term of this sequence.

..... **[2]**

(c) Explain why 150 is not a term in this sequence.

..... **[1]**

5 **(a)** Find the nth term of the sequence.

5 9 13 17 21

..... **[2]**

(b) Find the nth term of the sequence.

2 6 18 54 162

..... **[2]**

6 The first four terms of a sequence are

7 11 15 19

(a) Write down the next two terms of the sequence.

..... **[1]**

(b) Find an expression for the nth term of this sequence.

nth term = ... **[2]**

(c) Explain why 102 is not a term in this sequence.

..... **[2]**

7 **(a)** Sequence A is a linear sequence.

$$5 \quad 9 \quad 13 \quad 17 \quad \ldots$$

(i) Find the next two terms of sequence A.

..... **[1]**

(ii) Find the nth term of sequence A.

..... **[2]**

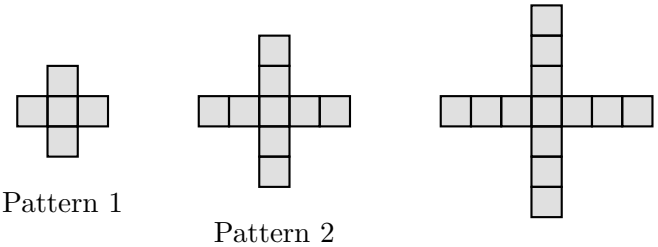
(b) Sequence B is a geometric sequence.

$$2 \quad 6 \quad 18 \quad 54 \quad \ldots$$

Find the nth term of sequence B.

..... **[2]**

8 The diagram shows a sequence of patterns made from small squares.



Pattern 1 Pattern 2 Pattern 3

(a) Find the number of squares in Pattern 4.

..... **[1]**

(b) Find an expression, in terms of n, for the number of squares in Pattern n.

..... **[2]**

(c) Which pattern has exactly 141 squares?

Pattern ..... **[2]**

9 The first four terms of a sequence are

$$-1 \quad 4 \quad 13 \quad 26$$

(a) Find an expression for the nth term of the sequence.

..... **[3]**

(b) Find the value of n when the nth term is 433.

$n =$ ..... **[3]**

10 The first five terms of a sequence, T_n, are given below.

$$4 \qquad 14 \qquad 34 \qquad 68 \qquad 120$$

(a) By finding the first, second and third differences, show that the nth term of the sequence is a cubic expression in n.

[2]

(b) Find an expression for T_n, the nth term of the sequence.

$T_n =$ ..... **[5]**

11 Here are the first five terms of a sequence.

3 9 17 27 39

Find an expression, in terms of n, for the nth term of this sequence.

..... **[3]**

12 Here are the first five terms of a sequence.

4 11 22 37 56

(a) Work out the next term of the sequence.

..... **[1]**

(b) Find an expression for the nth term of the sequence.

..... **[3]**

13 The nth term of a sequence is $u_n = an^2 + bn$.

(a) Given that $u_1 = 5$ and $u_2 = 14$, write down two simultaneous equations in a and b.

.....

..... **[2]**

(b) Solve these simultaneous equations to find the value of a and the value of b.

$a =$ ..... , $b =$ ..... **[3]**

14 **(a)** The nth term of a sequence is $n^2 - 3n + 5$.
Work out the first three terms of this sequence.

1st term = ... , 2nd term = ... , 3rd term = ...
[2]

(b) The first four terms of another sequence are

2 9 20 35

Find an expression for the nth term of this sequence.

..... **[3]**

15 The first four terms of a sequence, T, are

$$2 \quad 9 \quad 22 \quad 41$$

(a) Find an expression for the nth term, T_n.

$T_n =$ ..... **[3]**

(b) A second sequence is given by the formula $U_n = 2^n + 3$.
Work out the value of U_5.

$U_5 =$ ..... **[1]**

(c) Find the value of n for which $U_n = 131$.

$n =$ ..... **[2]**

16 The first four terms of a sequence are

$$-1 \quad 2 \quad 9 \quad 20$$

(a) Find the nth term of this sequence.

..... **[3]**

(b) The nth term of another sequence is given by $3^n - 2$.
Find the value of the term in this sequence that is closest to 1000.

..... **[3]**

17 The first five terms of a sequence are

2 9 20 35 54 ...

(a) Find the next term.

..... **[1]**

(b) Find the nth term of the sequence.

..... **[3]**

(c) The kth term of the sequence is 464.
Find the value of k.

$k =$ ..... **[3]**

18 Consider the following three sequences, P, Q and R.
Sequence P:

$$2 \quad 9 \quad 28 \quad 65 \quad 126 \quad \ldots$$

Sequence Q:

$$3 \quad 8 \quad 15 \quad 24 \quad 35 \quad \ldots$$

Sequence R:

$$\frac{2}{3} \quad \frac{9}{8} \quad \frac{28}{15} \quad \frac{65}{24} \quad \frac{126}{35} \quad \ldots$$

(a) Find the nth term of sequence P.

..... **[2]**

(b) Find the nth term of sequence Q.

..... **[2]**

(c) Write down the nth term of sequence R.

..... **[1]**

(d) Find the 12th term of sequence R, giving your answer as a fraction in its simplest form.

..... **[2]**

19 Here are the first five terms of a sequence.

2 9 28 65 126

(a) Find the next term of this sequence.

..... **[1]**

(b) Find an expression for the nth term of this sequence.

..... **[3]**

(c) The kth term of the sequence is 8001.
Find the value of k.

$k =$ ..... **[3]**

20 The table shows the first five terms of sequences A, B and C.

n	1	2	3	4	5
Sequence A	2	5	10	17	26
Sequence B	1	8	27	64	125
Sequence C	-1	3	17	47	99

(a) Find the nth term of sequence A.

..... **[2]**

(b) Find the nth term of sequence B.

..... **[1]**

(c) Use your answers to parts (a) and (b) to find an expression, in terms of n, for the nth term of sequence C.
Give your answer in its simplest form.

..... **[2]**

(d) Determine which term in sequence A has a value of 10001.

$n =$ ..... **[2]**

21 **(a)** The first five terms of a sequence are

$$-1 \quad 8 \quad 33 \quad 80 \quad 155$$

Use the method of differences to find an expression for the nth term of this sequence.

..... **[4]**

(b) An exponential sequence has nth term $P_n = 5 \times 3^{n-1}$.
The kth term of this sequence is 3645.
Work out the value of k.

$k =$ ..... **[2]**

(c) The nth term of sequence T is $T_n = \dfrac{2n-1}{3n+2}$.
Write down the value that T_n approaches as n becomes very large.

..... **[1]**

22 **(a)** A sequence has the following first four terms:

1 15 53 127

Use the method of differences to find an expression for the nth term.

nth term = ... **[4]**

(b) Another sequence, V, has its nth term defined by

$$V_n = \frac{n^2 + 1}{2^n}$$

(i) Find the values of V_1, V_2 and V_3.
Give each fraction in its simplest form.

V_1 = ... , V_2 = ... , V_3 = ... **[2]**

(ii) Work out the exact value of $V_5 - V_4$.

..... **[3]**

23 **(a)** The first five terms of a sequence are

4 5 14 37 80

Use the method of differences to find an expression for the nth term.

..... **[4]**

(b) The nth term of a different sequence is given by $T_n = a \times 2^n + b$.
The first term of this sequence is 10 and the third term is 34.

Find the values of a and b.

$a =$ ..... , $b =$ ..... **[4]**

(c) Calculate the 12th term of the sequence described in part (b).

..... **[2]**

24 The first five terms of three sequences, A, B and C, are shown below.

Sequence A: 5 9 13 17 21

Sequence B: 2 6 20 50 102

Sequence C: $\frac{5}{2}$ $\frac{3}{2}$ $\frac{13}{20}$ $\frac{17}{50}$ $\frac{7}{34}$

(a) Find the nth term of sequence A.

..... **[2]**

(b) **(i)** Work out the 6th term of sequence B.

..... **[1]**

(ii) Find an expression for the nth term of sequence B.

..... **[4]**

(c) **(i)** Work out the 6th term of sequence C, giving your answer as a fraction in its simplest form.

..... **[1]**

(ii) Find an expression for the nth term of sequence C.

..... **[2]**

1 **(a)** 27 **[B1]**

(b) Identifies the common difference of 4, e.g. writes $4n$ **[M1]**

$4n + 3$ **[A1]**

[Back to Question] *[Total Marks: 3]*

2 **(a)** 29 **[B1]**

(b) M1 for $6n + k$ where k is an integer

$6n - 1$ **[A1]**

(c) States that 150 is even but all terms in the sequence are odd OR solves $6n - 1 = 150$ to get $n = 25.1...$ and states n must be an integer **[B1]**

[Back to Question] *[Total Marks: 4]*

3 **(a)** 33 **[B1]**

(b) $7n + k$ for any integer k **[M1]**

$7n - 2$ **[A1]**

(c) $7n - 2 = 150$

$7\text{n} = 152 which does not give an integer value for \text{n}.[B1]$

[Back to Question] *[Total Marks: 4]*

4 **(a)** 29 **[B1]**

(b) $6n + c$ or finding common difference of 6 **[M1]**

$6n - 1$ **[A1]**

(c) Sets $6n - 1 = 150 \implies 6n = 151$ and states that 151 is not divisible by 6 (or n is not an integer) **[B1]**

[Back to Question] *[Total Marks: 4]*

5 **(a)** Common difference is 4 **[M1]**

$4n + 1$ **[A1]**

(b) Identifies common ratio is 3 **[M1]**

$2 \times 3^{n-1}$ **[A1]**

[Back to Question] *[Total Marks: 4]*

6 **(a)** $23, 27$ **[B1]**

(b) $4n + k$ (for any k) **[M1]**

$4n + 3$ **[A1]**

(c) Equates $4n + 3 = 102$ and attempts to solve for n **[M1]**

$n = 24.75$, which is not a whole number/integer **[A1]**

[Back to Question] *[Total Marks: 5]*

7 (a) (i) 21 and 25 **[B1]**

(ii) Identifies common difference of 4 leading to $4n$ **[M1]**

$4n + 1$ **[A1]**

(b) Identifies common ratio of 3 **[M1]**

$2 \times 3^{n-1}$ **[A1]**

[Back to Question] *[Total Marks: 5]*

8 (a) 17 **[B1]**

(b) $4n + c$ where c is a constant **[M1]**

$4n + 1$ **[A1]**

(c) $4n + 1 = 141$ or $141 - 1 = 140$ **[M1]**

35 **[A1]**

[Back to Question] *[Total Marks: 5]*

9 (a) Identifying the second differences are constant 4 **[M1]**

Deducing the n^2 coefficient is 2, or setting up $2n^2 + bn + c$ **[M1]**

$2n^2 - n - 2$ **[A1]**

(b) $2n^2 - n - 2 = 433$ **[M1]**

$2n^2 - n - 435 = 0$ leading to correct factorisation $(2n + 29)(n - 15) = 0$ or correct substitution into the quadratic formula **[M1]**

15 (must reject negative solution if given) **[A1]**

[Back to Question] *[Total Marks: 6]*

10 (a) First differences: $10, 20, 34, 52$ **[M1]**

Second differences: $10, 14, 18$
Third differences: $4, 4$
Since the third difference is a non-zero constant, the sequence is cubic. **[A1]**

(b) Uses $6a = 4 \implies a = \frac{2}{3}$ **[M1]**

Uses $12a + 2b = 10 \implies 12(\frac{2}{3}) + 2b = 10 \implies 8 + 2b = 10 \implies b = 1$ **[M1]**

Uses $7a + 3b + c = 10 \implies 7(\frac{2}{3}) + 3(1) + c = 10 \implies c = 10 - 3 - \frac{14}{3} = \frac{7}{3}$ **[M1]**

Uses $a+b+c+d=4 \implies \frac{2}{3}+1+\frac{7}{3}+d=4 \implies 4+d=4 \implies d=0$ **[M1]**

$\frac{2}{3}n^3+n^2+\frac{7}{3}n$ **[A1]**

[Back to Question] *[Total Marks: 7]*

11 Finds the first differences $6, 8, 10, 12$ and a constant second difference of 2 **[M1]**

Deduces that n^2 is part of the nth term expression **[M1]**

n^2+3n-1 **[A1]**

[Back to Question] *[Total Marks: 3]*

12 (a) 79 **[B1]**

(b) Calculates second differences to be 4, or equates $2a=4$ **[M1]**

Deduces that the sequence contains $2n^2$ **[M1]**

$2n^2+n+1$ **[A1]**

[Back to Question] *[Total Marks: 4]*

13 (a) $a+b=5$ **[B1]**

$4a+2b=14$ **[B1]**

(b) M1 for a correct method to eliminate one variable, e.g. multiplying the first equation by 2 to give $2a+2b=10$ and subtracting from the second equation

$2a=4$ leading to $a=2$ **[A1]**

$b=3$ **[A1]**

[Back to Question] *[Total Marks: 5]*

14 (a) One correct term evaluated **[M1]**

$3, 3, 5$ **[A1]**

(b) Second differences are 4 **[M1]**

Identifies $2n^2$ as part of the expression **[M1]**

$2n^2+n-1$ **[A1]**

[Back to Question] *[Total Marks: 5]*

15 (a) Finds first differences of $7, 13, 19$ and constant second differences of 6 **[M1]**

Deduces the quadratic term is $3n^2$ **[M1]**

$3n^2-2n+1$ **[A1]**

(b) 35 **[B1]**

(c) $2^n + 3 = 131$ leading to $2^n = 128$ **[M1]**

7 **[A1]**

[Back to Question] *[Total Marks: 6]*

16 **(a)** Finds first differences: $3, 7, 11$ and second differences: $4, 4$ **[M1]**

Deduces the term involves $2n^2$ **[M1]**

$2n^2 - 3$ **[A1]**

(b) $3^n - 2 \approx 1000 \implies 3^n \approx 1002$ **[M1]**

Uses logarithms or trial and improvement: $n = 6 \implies 3^6 - 2 = 729 - 2 = 727$; $n = 7 \implies 3^7 - 2 = 2187 - 2 = 2185$ **[M1]**

727 **[A1]**

[Back to Question] *[Total Marks: 6]*

17 **(a)** 77 **[B1]**

(b) Finds first differences $(7, 11, 15, 19)$ and constant second difference of 4 **[M1]**

Deduces the coefficient of n^2 is 2 **[A1]**

Subtracts $2n^2$ from the sequence terms to identify the linear sequence $n - 1$ **[M1]**

$2n^2 + n - 1$ **[A1]**

(c) Sets up the equation $2k^2 + k - 1 = 464$ **[M1]**

Rearranges to form a quadratic equal to zero: $2k^2 + k - 465 = 0$ **[M1]**

15 **[A1]**

[Back to Question] *[Total Marks: 7]*

18 **(a)** Recognises the relationship to cube numbers $(1, 8, 27, 64, 125)$ **[M1]**

$n^3 + 1$ **[A1]**

(b) Identifies second difference is 2, or relates to square numbers **[M1]**

$n^2 + 2n$ or $(n+1)^2 - 1$ **[A1]**

(c) $\dfrac{n^3 + 1}{n^2 + 2n}$ **[B1]**

(d) Substitutes $n = 12$ into their expression for sequence R, yielding $\dfrac{1728 + 1}{144 + 24}$ or $\dfrac{1729}{168}$ **[M1]**

Simplifies the fraction correctly to $\dfrac{247}{24}$ **[A1]**

[Back to Question] *[Total Marks: 7]*

19 **(a)** 217 **[B1]**

(b) M1 for finding the first differences $(7, 19, 37, 61)$ and second differences $(12, 18, 24)$

M1 for finding third differences are constant at 6, implying an n^3 term (or recognizing the sequence is $1^3 + 1, 2^3 + 1, 3^3 + 1, ...$)

$n^3 + 1$ **[A1]**

(c) M1 for setting up the equation $k^3 + 1 = 8001$

M1 for $k^3 = 8000$

$k = 20$ **[A1]**

[Back to Question] *[Total Marks: 7]*

20 **(a)** Identifies second difference of 2 or relates to square numbers **[M1]**

$n^2 + 1$ **[A1]**

(b) n^3 **[B1]**

(c) Recognises the relationship that Sequence C is Sequence B minus Sequence A **[M1]**

$n^3 - n^2 - 1$ **[A1]**

(d) Sets up the correct equation: $n^2 + 1 = 10001$ or $n^2 = 10000$ **[M1]**

100 **[A1]**

[Back to Question] *[Total Marks: 7]*

21 **(a)** Finds third differences are 6 (first diffs: $9, 25, 47, 75$; second diffs: $16, 22, 28$; third diffs: 6) **[M1]**

Identifies n^3 as the cubic term **[B1]**

Subtracts n^3 from the sequence to get a quadratic sequence $(-2, 0, 6, 16, 30)$ and finds its second differences are 4 to give $2n^2$ **[M1]**

$n^3 + 2n^2 - 4n$ **[A1]**

(b) $5 \times 3^{k-1} = 3645$

$3^{k-1} = 729$ [M1]

7 **[A1]**

(c) $\frac{2}{3}$ or 0.667 **[B1]**

[Back to Question] *[Total Marks: 7]*

22 **(a)** Finds first differences $14, 38, 74$ and second differences $24, 36$ **[M1]**

Finds third difference of 12 leading to a cubic term of $2n^3$ **[M1]**

Evaluates the sequence of residuals $T_n - 2n^3$ to find a constant difference of -1 **[M1]**

$2n^3 - 1$ **[A1]**

(b) **(i)** $V_1 = 1$, $V_2 = \frac{5}{4}$, $V_3 = \frac{5}{4}$ **[B2]**

Award B1 if any two are correct **[B1]**

(ii) Substitutes $n = 5$ to find $V_5 = \dfrac{25+1}{32} = \dfrac{13}{16}$ **[B1]**

Substitutes $n = 4$ to find $V_4 = \dfrac{16+1}{16} = \dfrac{17}{16}$ **[B1]**

Evaluates $\dfrac{13}{16} - \dfrac{17}{16} = -\dfrac{1}{4}$ (accept -0.25) **[A1]**

[Back to Question] *[Total Marks: 9]*

23 **(a)** Correct first differences $1, 9, 23, 43$ and second differences $8, 14, 20$ and third differences 6 **[M1]**

Deducing the cubic term coefficient is $a = 6 \div 6 = 1$ **[B1]**

Setting up equations to solve for other coefficients, e.g. $12a + 2b = 8$ **[M1]**

$n^3 - 2n^2 + 5$ **[A1]**

(b) $2a + b = 10$ **[B1]**

$8a + b = 34$ **[B1]**

Correct method to solve simultaneous equations, e.g. subtracting to get $6a = 24$ **[M1]**

$a = 4, b = 2$ **[A1]**

(c) Substituting $n = 12$ into their $4 \times 2^n + 2$ **[M1]**

16386 **[A1]**

[Back to Question] *[Total Marks: 10]*

24 **(a)** $4n + 1$ **[B2]**

If $4n + k$ seen, award **[M1]**

(b) **(i)** 182 **[B1]**

(ii) Identifies third differences are constant (6), so term contains n^3 **[M1]**

Subtracts n^3 terms $(1, 8, 27, 64, 125)$ from the sequence **[M1]**

Remainder sequence is $1, -2, -7, -14, -23$ **[M1]**

Deduces the remainder is $-n^2 + 2$ **[M1]**

$n^3 - n^2 + 2$ **[A1]**

(c) **(i)** $\dfrac{25}{182}$ **[B1]**

(ii) Recognises the pattern is Sequence A divided by Sequence B **[M1]**

$\dfrac{4n+1}{n^3 - n^2 + 2}$ **[A1]**

[Back to Question] *[Total Marks: 10]*